

Hey, friends. Eric Malzone here. And in this audio lecture, we are going to talk about titling your podcast.

I have witnessed new podcasters absolutely agonize over the name of their podcast. I may have been that person. I was definitely that person.

So if that is your experience so far, do not worry. You are not alone. And for numerous reasons that we'll touch on here, it is very, very important to nail down that title.

But the most important component of starting a podcast is that you actually start. So for a few, the title will be obvious and easy to nail down. These are the blessed ones.

For some, that means start recording before you even know the name. Get a few episodes under your belt. Maybe something will come to you as you go. But don't let it hold you back.

For others, it means that you may rebrand once or several times throughout the journey. Whatever it is, let's discuss some strategies and tactics on how to create a great title for your podcast.

So why is it important? Well, first impressions. Along with your podcast network, podcast title is the first thing potential listeners see.

When it's done right, it can tell the story in just a few simple words. A strong title also resonates specifically with your target audience. Along with your unique personality, this is what drives people to click and subscribe.

The less descriptive or indirect titles tend to take longer to get traction, as a simple rule. But on the flip side, they can also allow for a little bit more creativity. So we'll talk about that in a minute.

Brand identity-- ugh, defining brand, right? It's such an ethereal concept. I find that it's a multifaceted endeavor, encompassing both the physical elements like design and logo and the experiential and emotional components of being human, like reputation and customer experience.

Now, Ryan Reynolds is a brand, but so is Coca-Cola. So how do you balance those two things out? People far smarter than me can define it far better. But for the sake of our conversation here, let's just say it's the connection a person has with a product, service, event, community, or individual. Whether you have an established brand or looking to build one, it is an important consideration for your podcast.

So talk about brand extension. If you have an existing brand and you want the podcast to be another media outlet for the brand, there's some really good examples. There's some obvious ones, like The WHOOP Podcast, presented by WHOOP. The Dr. Axe Show, or Ted Talks Daily, an extension of the premier Ted Talks that we all know and love.

The key elements of an effective podcast title, clarity and relevance-- two very important concepts. Being clear and being relevant quickly convey the podcast name and resonate with the target audience. So I'm going to give you some examples and talk through them.

Barbell Shrug-- it speaks directly to CrossFit. If you're not in the CrossFit world, it may mean nothing to you. It may be really weird, actually. But to those particular people in that niche, it resonates very, very well.

The Menopause Coach, kind of speaks for itself. Trail Runner Nation, also rather self-explanatory. Biggest thing is you want to avoid using jargon or overly clever names that might confuse potential listeners-- unless you have a unique advantage, as if being Tom Brady, right? He can call it whatever he wants, it's probably going to be successful.

Brevity-- I would generally advise keeping titles concise. Specifically, I would say five words or less. Shorter titles are just simply easier to remember, easier to share and easier to manage-- especially in the visuals of your podcast, like the artwork and things like that, and the socials. So brevity is key. There's ways to extend that title if you want more verbiage within it, and we'll talk about that in a minute.

Keyword optimization-- so this is a deep rabbit hole, but it's definitely worth considering when you're starting a new podcast. Using tools like Google Trends or other keyword planners out there can be used to help you find popular terms that are very specific to your niche.

OK, brainstorming techniques. After you've done a little bit of research, you've defined some parameters, it's time to actually get down to the brainstorming. I've always found that mind-mapping is extremely useful.

So what is mind-mapping? It's mostly a visual technique. It's used to organize your thoughts, generate ideas, facilitate creativity. It involves creating a central concept or idea, and then branching it out into related subtopics, wording, forming a kind of hierarchical structure.

So there are a lot of softwares you can use for it-- Coggle, C-O-G-G-L-E. I've used Lucidchart quite a bit in the past. But I've always preferred the old-fashioned whiteboard. It's just nice having that actual feel and that physicality to it as you're moving around the room and thinking.

So I'm also a kinetic thinker. So you've got to figure out, how do you get creative? What are your creative states? And go seek those out as you start to really brainstorm what the title is going to be.

So start out by maybe listing some key themes, some topics, words associated with your podcast. Just simply sit with it a bit. Sit in the room, sleep on it. Let your subconscious do a little bit of work.

Another great tactic for this is audience feedback. So there is a ton of value in getting feedback from your target audience-- your friends, your family, your colleagues, people who know you well. I've always found that a help wanted style social media post, so putting something up on social media.

And saying, "hey, I'm starting a new podcast. Here's what I'm thinking. I need a new name. What do you got?" Or using a poll or a survey, something along those lines, you'll get some really, really awesome feedback and it's really valuable.

Competitive analysis-- so take some time to analyze successful podcasts in your niche, or those adjacent to your niche. You can find a ton of inspiration there, as well. And it's worth your time.

So testing and finalizing your title. Now we're starting to get a little bit more granular, but if you've gotten this far, why not? So A, B testing, they pick two or three different titles that you're mulling over. You're probably going to get to this point anyway naturally, where you have a couple really like and you're not really sure which direction to go. So you can, once again, use social media, or maybe a small group of listeners or test listeners that are in your niche, and get their insights into which one resonates with them more.

Legal considerations-- so this is really important. You don't want to get so deep into your podcast that you never actually consider trademarks or copyrighted titles. So use things like the USPTO database-- that's the United States Patent and Trademark Office-- and make sure that you're not infringing on any trademarks or copyrights. That will probably save you a lot of headache down the road.

OK, subtitles and taglines-- so I mentioned this a little bit a couple of minutes ago. But using your title, having a core title, but then using a subtitle or a tagline can really provide a lot of valuable additional context. So let me give you some examples, and I think this will kind speak for itself.

So how I built this awesome podcast. Their tagline is, "stories behind the people who created the companies we love." Boom. Awesome.

The Tim Ferriss Show-- he's one of my favorites. "Interviews with world class performers from eclectic areas." A new one I just checked out recently is called Armchair Expert. Tagline is, "A podcast that celebrates the messiness of being human." That's awesome, right? So this allows you to expand on your concepts, be a little bit more specific, and add some more character to it.

Brand consistency-- we've talked about brands a little bit in this audio lecture already. Just try to ensure that the subtitles or taglines also align with the podcaster's content and branding. You want to make sure that you have consistent language and tone across all the branding materials.

So those are just some simple ways and methods of coming up with a great title for your podcast. Take your time in choosing a title. It is a crucial step in your podcast journey. It should be a source of excitement, a source of pride, but also be grounded in practicality. Needs to be creative, but also be strategic.

Like many things in the podcasting world, it's equal parts arts and science. So that's it for this audio lecture. Hope you enjoyed it. Talk to you soon.

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